State machines for bounded agents

Learn to understand, design, build, test and explain AI systems responsibly.

Project: Grounded Learning Service

Prepare the purpose, prerequisites and materials

> Prepare State machines for bounded agents: check the target, prerequisites, resources and adaptable teaching schedule.

Teach the learning cycle

Primary target: Explain the **mechanism** and terminology of **state** machines for bounded agents

Session · Sequence and minutes · Resources

> **Session:** Session 1 · Understand · 45 min
>
> **Sequence and minutes:** 0–7: recall and prerequisite; 7–15: inspect the concrete case and predict; 15–30: teacher models the worked trace; 30–40: learners explain a step using the text and visual; 40–45: check the core idea.
>
> **Resources:** Use Your mission, Notice the evidence, See how it works, Words that unlock the idea and Follow a worked example; record recall in the workbook.

> **Session:** Session 2 · Practise · 45 min
>
> **Sequence and minutes:** 0–5: retrieve the procedure; 5–15: W2 completion practice; 15–23: explain and check with a partner; 23–30: each learner answers the misconception check; 30–40: targeted reteaching or a harder variation; 40–45: prepare the investigation.
>
> **Resources:** Use Find and repair a mistake, Practise together and Build your understanding; use the matching workbook W2 and Individual reasoning check.

> **Session:** Session 3 · Investigate and transfer · 45 min
>
> **Sequence and minutes:** 0–5: retrieve the decision rule; 5–20: investigate or trace; 20–30: start the independent case; 30–38: connect the project; 38–43: act on feedback; 43–45: plan the return check.
>
> **Resources:** Use Run the investigation, Connect your project and Try a new case independently. Allow extra time for the full task set. When code is supplied, use the examples in See how it works or Follow a worked example and the browser lab in Supported practice, repair and portfolio.

This is a starting allocation of 135 minutes, not a validated duration. Preserve all named topics. Schedule extra time for connected examples, the full investigation, independent cases and project building.

Repeated copies of a case share one recorded attempt; they are not new **evidence**.

Case exposure check: this source example appears in ai-2/30, ai-6/13. Reuse a familiar case for recall or modelling; verify that the case used to assess transfer has not already received feedback.

Retrieval answer guidance

Logs traces and privacy

Without opening the old lesson, explain one key idea from Logs traces and privacy. Give an example and a mistake that the idea helps you avoid.

Look for: Explain the **mechanism** and terminology of logs traces and privacy

Reference example, not the only acceptable wording: Teacher explanation: Logs support diagnosis, but excessive recording can expose private content. Trace IDs link stages without storing complete sensitive **input**s.

For this policy log trace ID, stage, status, duration and error category; do not log passcodes, student text or teacher answers. Restrict access and declare retention.

Evaluation pipelines

Without opening the old lesson, explain one key idea from Evaluation pipelines. Give an example and a mistake that the idea helps you avoid.

Look for: Explain the **mechanism** and terminology of evaluation pipelines

Reference example, not the only acceptable wording: Teacher explanation: Evaluation pipelines preserve case versions, procedure versions and raw outcomes before producing metrics. A rerun must identify what changed.

Load versioned cases, validate expected outcomes, execute the frozen system, store case-level results and compute declared denominators. Reject missing results rather than silently counting them as success.

Testing pure components

Without opening the old lesson, explain one key idea from Testing pure components. Give an example and a mistake that the idea helps you avoid.

Look for: Explain the **mechanism** and terminology of testing pure components

Reference example, not the only acceptable wording: Teacher explanation: Pure components return results from supplied **input**s without external side effects. They are easier to test with exact expected values.

Define remaining(capacity, used)=capacity-used for integer **input**s satisfying 0<=used<=capacity. Invalid types/ranges raise an explicit validation error. Test zero and equality boundaries.

Two 45-minute sessions. A bounded agent uses explicit **state**s and finite action limits. A **state** machine makes invalid **transition**s visible. Use the supplied constructed scenarios to make the **mechanism** inspectable.

Collect W4 before sharing solutions. Students should name intermediate **evidence** and limitations; classroom pacing and learning effectiveness remain unvalidated.

Outcomes

Explain the **mechanism** and terminology of **state** machines for bounded agents

Apply the **state**d procedure to a new case with a traceable result

Identify an assumption or limitation and design a revealing follow-up

Preparation

Lesson and workbook; paper and pencil

Calculator and optional local Python 3 for arithmetic; no live API or private data

Prepare the fresh retry separately and withhold its solution until after collection

Prerequisite answer

A result depends on the **input**s, procedure and conditions that produced it. Preserve data roles and distinguish observed outcomes from **prediction**s or unmeasured conditions.

If the prior concept cannot be explained, use a short retrieval activity before this chapter.

End goal for the pictorial case

Explain **state** machines for bounded agents using the deciding step in this fictional service.

This added worked case illustrates the week's main idea. Retain all original and connected topics; schedule its practice within the teaching cycle.

Explain and model the mechanism

> Model State machines for bounded agents using the supplied case, labelled mechanism and reasoning. Make the scope of each conclusion explicit.

A bounded agent uses explicit **state**s and finite action limits. A **state** machine makes invalid **transition**s visible.

Explain State machines for bounded agents · 1

Begin by writing the question the procedure is intended to answer. Identify the information already supplied, the information it will produce and the information still missing.

These are constructed classroom examples; they do not require live accounts, private records or an external service. Do not treat a plausible explanation as a measured outcome.

States are ready, looking_up, review, done. ready may start lookup; lookup may finish done or request review; review may finish done after authorised **evidence**. done is terminal. Maximum two lookup attempts.

Explain State machines for bounded agents · 2

Before applying the procedure, write its units, denominator or decision boundary where relevant. A partner should be able to repeat each step using the same **input**s.

If a required **input** is absent or violates the **state**d contract, record that condition explicitly instead of quietly replacing it with a convenient value.

Term	Meaning
State	A declared stage of a process
Transition	An allowed move between states
Terminal state	A state with no further operations under the contract

State machines for bounded agents — evidence trace

INPUT AND SCOPE

Trace ready -> looking_up -> review -> looking_up -> done.

CHECK OR CALCULATION

States are ready, looking_up, review, done. ready may start lookup; lookup may finish done or request review; review may finish done after authorised evidence. done is terminal. Maximum two lookup attempts.

CONCLUSION AND LIMIT

review -> looking_up is not allowed by this declared transition table, even if total attempts is two. Reject the transition or explicitly redesign and retest the table.

The figure connects this chapter's worked input, declared procedure and result. Read the complete worked reasoning for qualifiers and intermediate steps; the abbreviated labels do not replace that reasoning.

Explain State machines for bounded agents · 3

Guided: review -> looking_up is not allowed by this declared **transition** table, even if total attempts is two. Reject the **transition** or explicitly redesign and retest the table.

Qualification: An action budget and a **transition** policy are separate checks; satisfying one does not guarantee the other.

Exit: accept a concrete variation with its predicted outcome and a **state**d condition that would challenge the **mechanism**; reject a claim resting on unmeasured **evidence**.

Model the reasoning aloud

Use the complete worked example below before asking learners to complete W2. Reveal a small part, invite a **prediction**, then explain the deciding step.

These teacher notes contain solutions; do not reveal the independent case answer during modelling.

Trace ready -> looking_up -> review -> looking_up -> done.

review -> looking_up is not allowed by this declared **transition** table, even if total attempts is two. Reject the **transition** or explicitly redesign and retest the table.

Model the reasoning aloud · 4

Compare the intermediate **evidence** with the final **state**ment. Explain why each number or decision follows from the **state**d **input**s.

The conclusion belongs to this scenario and procedure; changing the **input**s, evaluation population or authority can change what it establishes. Retain the raw record so a later revision can be compared honestly.

Model the reasoning aloud · 5

Optional local lab: predict the printed result before running this standalone Python 3 example. Change one relevant boundary **input**, record the outcome and **state** the contract or statistical assumptions.

The program uses fictional values and the Python standard library; it performs no external operations.

```
def transition(state, target):
    allowed = {'ready': {'looking_up'}, 'looking_up': {'review', 'done'}, 'review':
{'done'}, 'done': set()}
    if target not in allowed.get(state, set()):
        raise ValueError('invalid transition')
    return target

print(transition("ready", "looking_up"))
```

Thinking move	Teacher prompt
Plan	What is given? What is the question? Which procedure fits these facts?
Do	Point to each input and intermediate step in the worked trace. Name the rule that allows the next step.
Check	Does the output answer the question? Which assumption or limitation prevents a larger claim?

Use the diagram and verbal explanation together. Ask learners to match a sentence to a specific visual step; do not assign learners fixed visual or auditory learning styles.

A pictorial worked case: State machines for bounded agents

A parcel lookup **state** machine. An agent may follow idle→querying→checking→complete; complete is terminal.

The facts we will use

> ### Supplied facts
>
> A follows all four **state**s. B follows idle→querying→complete. No other **transition**s are declared.

AI ACADEMY / AI-6/13

State machines for bounded agents

Start with the supplied facts

Follow each arrow. Ask which fact allows the next step.



1. Read arrows

The graph permits three forward transitions.



2. Follow A

All adjacent pairs match permitted arrows.



3. Inspect B

Querying -> complete skips checking and is invalid.

CHANGE ONE THING

Add checking -> querying as a permitted retry.

Explain the changed result using the matching lesson.

Follow the labelled picture with the matching explanation. Open the vector diagram

Read the picture one step at a time

STEP	WHAT HAPPENS AND WHY
1. Read arrows	The graph permits three forward transitions.
2. Follow A	All adjacent pairs match permitted arrows.
3. Inspect B	Querying→complete skips checking and is invalid.

Match each pictured step to the supplied facts. This is a worked teaching case, not an independent assessment.

Why this result follows

Why the result follows

A **state** machine bounds action order. A plausible final **state** does not establish that the path was valid.

What this example does not establish

Keep the stated limit

This graph checks sequence, not the correctness of the fetched parcel data.

Change one thing in the pictured case

Change one thing

Change: Add checking→querying as a permitted retry.

Predicted result

Prediction: That retry becomes valid; querying→complete stays forbidden.

Why the result follows

Reason: Adding one arrow does not authorise unrelated shortcuts.

Ask while showing the picture

Ask while showing the picture · 6

Cover the result. Ask learners to name the **input**s and predict the next step. Uncover one step, connect the icon to the actual procedure, and explain its **evidence**. Then change the supplied condition and compare.

The picture is a representation; it does not document execution of a real AI model.

Demonstrate and guide practice

> Demonstrate State machines for bounded agents, reduce support deliberately and check individual reasoning before discussing answers.

Time or stage	Teacher action
Session 1: 0–7 minutes	Retrieve the prerequisite; identify the input, procedure and evidence source.
7–18 minutes	Explain section 1 and vocabulary. Complete W1 with a mechanism-based explanation.
18–32 minutes	Trace the declared procedure and worked case. Complete W2, recording intermediate steps.
32–45 minutes	Discuss the diagram with the worked input; use W3 to distinguish measured claims and limitations.
Session 2: 0–8 minutes	Retrieve the worked reasoning and collect the guided response before discussing it.
8–20 minutes	Compare a proposed boundary variant with the original case; identify what remains fixed.
20–35 minutes	Collect W4 independently. Require the procedure trace and the bounded conclusion.
35–45 minutes	Use W5 and exit responses for feedback. Administer the fresh retry after feedback and preserve both attempts.

Use See how it works and Follow a worked example. Collect a **prediction** before revealing its result; ask the learner to point to each intermediate fact.

Provide an **input**/procedure/result/limit frame and a calculator when needed. Ask students to identify the first step before completing the whole trace.

Extension: compare two concrete variants of this **mechanism** while holding unrelated conditions fixed; report both successful and unsuccessful outcomes.

Reduce help deliberately

Completion practice

Completion task: Trace ready -> looking_up -> review -> looking_up -> done. Show the intermediate steps and give the conclusion with its scope.

Reasoning to listen for

Teacher check: Teacher explanation: review -> looking_up is not allowed by this declared **transition** table, even if total attempts is two. Reject the **transition** or explicitly redesign and retest the table.

Start by identifying the given **input**s together. Leave the intermediate steps blank. If needed, model one step, then withdraw that help on the next step. Move to a full trace only when the partial trace is understood.

For partners, alternate explainer and checker; collect a response from every learner before discussion.

Individual reasoning check

Use the worked case for **State** machines for bounded agents. Proposed explanation: “The worked result establishes every future case”. Decide whether this explanation is supported.

Point to the step or supplied fact that decides; explain your repair if needed.

Expected repair

Expected correction: An action budget and a **transition** policy are separate checks; satisfying one does not guarantee the other.

Collect explanations, not only yes/no votes. If a misunderstanding is common, re-model the relevant step for the class.

If it affects a few learners, give a short targeted group explanation while others solve a more demanding variation.

Pictorial practice question

Trace A and B through the **state** diagram. Name B’s forbidden **transition** and explain whether adding checking→querying permits that shortcut.

Reasoned teacher answer

The graph permits three forward **transition**s. All adjacent pairs match permitted arrows. Querying→complete skips checking and is invalid. Changed case: That retry becomes valid; querying→complete stays forbidden.

Adding one arrow does not authorise unrelated shortcuts.

Changed-case reasoning: That retry becomes valid; querying→complete stays forbidden. Adding one arrow does not authorise unrelated shortcuts.

Collect each learner's explanation before discussion. Use the first missing connection between **input**, deciding step and result to choose support. This question is worked-case practice, not fresh mastery **evidence**.

Run the investigation and diagnose misconceptions

> Run the State machines for bounded agents investigation and use the first unsupported step to choose a teaching response.

The worked result establishes every future case: An action budget and a **transition** policy are separate checks; satisfying one does not guarantee the other.

A missing **input** may be replaced without recording the change: A replacement changes the **evidence** or contract. Record the change and its justification; do not silently turn unknown into a measured value.

Repeating an assessed case is new independent **evidence**: A replay checks consistency. An example used for feedback or revision cannot later be described as untouched final evaluation.

Use Run the investigation for the **evidence** ledger. Add a boundary or missing-**input** case and record the expected response before checking. More successful repeats of one case do not establish wider coverage.

Match the support to the first error

What the response shows	Next teaching action
Missing or misread facts	Read the case aloud, mark supplied versus unknown facts, and let the learner restate it.
Wrong procedure	Return to the deciding step in the worked case. Contrast it with the proposed incorrect explanation.
Arithmetic or implementation error	Trace intermediate values or lines; preserve the first mismatch and retry that step.
Correct result without a reason	Ask for a trace and a changed case before marking independent understanding.
An unsupported wider claim	Ask which supplied evidence supports the claim and which further observation would be needed.

Offer an oral explanation, drawing, enlarged visual or fewer examples when that removes a reading/writing barrier. Keep the same reasoning goal.

Stretch secure learners by changing a boundary or assumption and asking them to defend the effect, not simply by assigning more of the same questions.

Assess and explain the answers

> Use the State machines for bounded agents questions, teacher keys and criteria after the relevant attempts. Previously discussed cases are practice; protect the separately selected independent task.

Guided and exit questions

Guided: review -> looking_up is not allowed by this declared **transition** table, even if total attempts is two. Reject the **transition** or explicitly redesign and retest the table.

Qualification: An action budget and a **transition** policy are separate checks; satisfying one does not guarantee the other.

Exit: accept a concrete variation with its predicted outcome and a **state**d condition that would challenge the **mechanism**; reject a claim resting on unmeasured **evidence**.

W1 Explain the mechanism

Workbook question · W1

Explain the weekly **mechanism** in your own words. Use the worked scenario to name its **input**, decision rule and **output**.

Teacher reasoning · W1

Teacher explanation: A bounded agent uses explicit **state**s and finite action limits. A **state** machine makes invalid **transition**s visible.

States are ready, looking_up, review, done. ready may start lookup; lookup may finish done or request review; review may finish done after authorised **evidence**. done is terminal. Maximum two lookup attempts.

W2 Trace the worked case

Workbook question · W2

Trace ready -> looking_up -> review -> looking_up -> done. Show the intermediate steps and give the conclusion with its scope.

Teacher reasoning · W2

Teacher explanation: review -> looking_up is not allowed by this declared **transition** table, even if total attempts is two. Reject the **transition** or explicitly redesign and retest the table.

W3 Audit the limit

Workbook question · W3

A report omits this qualification: An action budget and a **transition** policy are separate checks; satisfying one does not guarantee the other.

Explain how omitting it could change a reader's interpretation, and write an accurate replacement.

Teacher reasoning · W3

Teacher explanation: An action budget and a **transition** policy are separate checks; satisfying one does not guarantee the other.

State the observed result separately from the unverified or out-of-scope claim; preserve the original **evidence** rather than inventing a missing fact.

W4 Apply a new case independently

Workbook question · W4

Trace ready -> looking_up -> review -> done -> looking_up. Find first invalid **transition**.

Teacher reasoning · W4

Teacher explanation: done -> looking_up violates terminal-**state** rule; stop. Earlier **transition**s are permitted.

W5 Design a revealing follow-up

Workbook question · W5

For the worked scenario, propose one additional case that could reveal a failure, describe its expected outcome before running it, and explain what would need to remain fixed for a fair comparison.

Do not reuse W4 as a new final test after receiving feedback.

Teacher reasoning · W5

Teacher explanation: Accept a concrete variant of the worked **input** or a missing/conflicting/boundary condition, with an expectation derived from the declared procedure.

Require preserved settings, original **output**s and data roles. An action budget and a **transition** policy are separate checks; satisfying one does not guarantee the other.

The new case should test this particular **mechanism** rather than merely re**state** the original result.

Independent assessment and fresh retry

Teacher key · Independent assessment and fresh retry

W4: done -> looking_up violates terminal-**state** rule; stop. Earlier **transition**s are permitted. Require intermediate reasoning and the **state**d scope. Fresh retry: ready -> looking_up -> done -> review.

Expected reasoning: done -> review invalid. A **terminal state** must not silently resume. If students need support, record it and reassess with another new case rather than awarding independence to a copied answer.

Assess independent transfer

Independent question · withhold the key

Selected case: Only these **transition**s are allowed: ready→looking_up→review→done. Done is terminal. Evaluate ready→review→done and ready→looking_up→review→done.

Selected case answer

Teacher key · Selected case answer

Teacher explanation: The first trace fails at ready→review because that arrow is absent from this case's allowed **transition**s. Do not continue an invalid trace as though it passed. The second trace ready→looking_up→review→done follows every declared arrow and ends at the terminal **state**. No **transition** may leave done.

Dimension	Evidence required
Explanation	Names the applicable idea or procedure and ties it to the supplied facts.
Trace and result	Preserves the given inputs and shows the relevant intermediate steps; distinguishes a prediction from an observed execution.
Limits	States the assumptions, missing evidence or conditions under which the result would change.

Teacher key · Selected case answer

Record each dimension as not yet, with support, or independent. Accept a valid alternative procedure with a defensible trace.

Do not penalise an honestly recorded model failure if the learner correctly explains its **evidence** and limits.

Feedback that the learner uses

Name the earliest unsupported step and give one action to repair it. Have the learner make that repair now and explain why. Then assess the relevant skill on a fresh, fully specified case.

Confirm it was not previously practised with feedback; solve and check the new case before assigning it. A follow-up design prompt is a starting brief, not automatically an equivalent test.

Connect the project, support and next lesson

> Connect State machines for bounded agents to Grounded Learning Service, adapt support and plan a later changed-case check.

Add a labelled **state** machines for bounded agents **evidence** sheet to Grounded Learning Service. Show how you can explain the **mechanism** and terminology of **state** machines for bounded agents.

Use the supplied fictional case and keep its **input**s, intermediate steps, calculation or **prediction**, and limitation. Connect this record to last week's record; a matching answer without a trace is insufficient.

Provide an **input**/procedure/result/limit frame and a calculator when needed. Ask students to identify the first step before completing the whole trace.

Extension: compare two concrete variants of this **mechanism** while holding unrelated conditions fixed; report both successful and unsuccessful outcomes.

Next connection: Planning and action selection. Preserve the current case record and retrieve its **evidence** boundary before moving on.

Retain the project ledger and assess a changed case after support. Check the relevant prerequisite before carrying this component forward.

Plan the delayed return

Suggested return points in this level: ai-6/14, ai-6/16, ai-6/19. Use actual classroom dates, adjusting for holidays and gaps. One, three and six teaching weeks are scheduling choices, not a claimed optimal spacing.

At a delayed check, ask for the idea from memory and a changed application. Compare with the earlier independent response and record support used.

For a new level, revisit the previous capstone before checking the new prerequisites.

Record	Teacher evidence
Learner code and date	
Concept and case used; prior exposure	
Explanation / trace / limits	
Support and first repair	
Changed case and delayed outcome	
Next teaching action	

Use the **evidence** to choose reteaching or the next step. A completed page, confidence rating or attractive project does not by itself demonstrate understanding.

Project evidence from this case

For the Grounded Learning Service, retain an annotated trace and the changed-case result. Name the contract or **evidence** that makes the deciding step valid, so another team can review it.

Prepare, teach and assess

> Use this preparation summary alongside the detailed State machines for bounded agents

lesson; it is a checklist rather than a replacement for the full sequence.

Teaching target

Teaching target: Explain the **mechanism** and terminology of **state** machines for bounded agents

Prepare the labelled worked-case picture, the matching workbook, fictional **input** cards and a place for individual responses. Check a local Python 3 environment before class; have a paper-trace version ready.

Session · Plan · Resources

Session: Session 1 · Understand · 45 min

Plan: 0–7: recall and prerequisite; 7–15: inspect the concrete case and predict; 15–30: teacher models the worked trace; 30–40: learners explain a step using the text and visual; 40–45: check the core idea.

Resources: Use Your mission, Notice the evidence, See how it works, Words that unlock the idea and Follow a worked example; record recall in the workbook.

Session: Session 2 · Practise · 45 min

Plan: 0–5: retrieve the procedure; 5–15: W2 completion practice; 15–23: explain and check with a partner; 23–30: each learner answers the misconception check; 30–40: targeted reteaching or a harder variation; 40–45: prepare the investigation.

Resources: Use Find and repair a mistake, Practise together and Build your understanding; use the matching workbook W2 and Individual reasoning check.

Session: Session 3 · Investigate and transfer · 45 min

Plan: 0–5: retrieve the decision rule; 5–20: investigate or trace; 20–30: start the independent case; 30–38: connect the project; 38–43: act on feedback; 43–45: plan the return check.

Resources: Use Run the investigation, Connect your project and Try a new case independently. Allow extra time for the full task set. When code is supplied, use the examples in See how it works or Follow a worked example and the browser lab in Supported practice, repair and

> portfolio.

Before class, solve the supported practice: Trace ready -> looking_up -> review -> looking_up -> done. Show the intermediate steps and give the conclusion with its scope.

Supported practice answer

Reasoned practice answer: Teacher explanation: review -> looking_up is not allowed by this declared **transition** table, even if total attempts is two. Reject the **transition** or explicitly redesign and retest the table.

Check every learner before discussion: Use the worked case for **State** machines for bounded agents. Proposed explanation: “The worked result establishes every future case”. Decide whether this explanation is supported.

Point to the step or supplied fact that decides; explain your repair if needed.

Repair the misconception

Misconception repair: An action budget and a **transition** policy are separate checks; satisfying one does not guarantee the other.

Support without giving away the answer

Support: read the exact case aloud, enlarge the labelled picture, supply **input** cards and model only the first deciding step. Accept a spoken explanation or drawing; retain the reasoning goal.

Extend the reasoning

Extension: Add checking→querying as a permitted retry. Require a **prediction** and a reason before comparing. Expected result: That retry becomes valid; querying→complete stays forbidden.

Reason: Adding one arrow does not authorise unrelated shortcuts.

Protect the independent attempt

Independent assessment: withhold the reserved answer until the learner has attempted the new case. Record support separately from correctness.

Criterion	Not yet	With support	Independent
Explanation	Names an answer without a deciding fact	Uses a hint to link fact and decision	Explains the deciding fact in own words
Trace or test	Cannot connect input and result	Completes steps with prompts	Traces or tests a changed case accurately
Limits and revision	Claims more than evidence supports	Names a limit after a prompt	States a defensible limit and useful next test

Project checkpoint

Project checkpoint: Test changed cases. Keep normal, boundary and failure cases; compare expected and observed results.

Use the weekly teacher answer for topic-specific reasoning. A saved progress tick is an activity record; judge mastery from the learner's explanation and **evidence**.

Use feedback, labs and repair paths

> Use feedback, earlier review and portfolios purposefully. Apply the coding routine only when this lesson has an executable lab.

Use the two formative questions as supported practice, not as independent mastery scores. Discuss the deciding **evidence** rather than accepting a guessed selection.

The feedback comes from the reviewed public worked case. Do not reveal the separately reserved independent teacher answer until the learner has attempted that case.

Ask students to predict before running code. Preserve errors and actual **output**s; collect a changed test and an explanation. The branch-boundary and indexing lessons deliberately include failure cases.

Use the earlier worked-explanation links to address a specific missing building block, then return to the current question. Adapt this suggestion after observing the learner; it is not an automatic diagnosis.

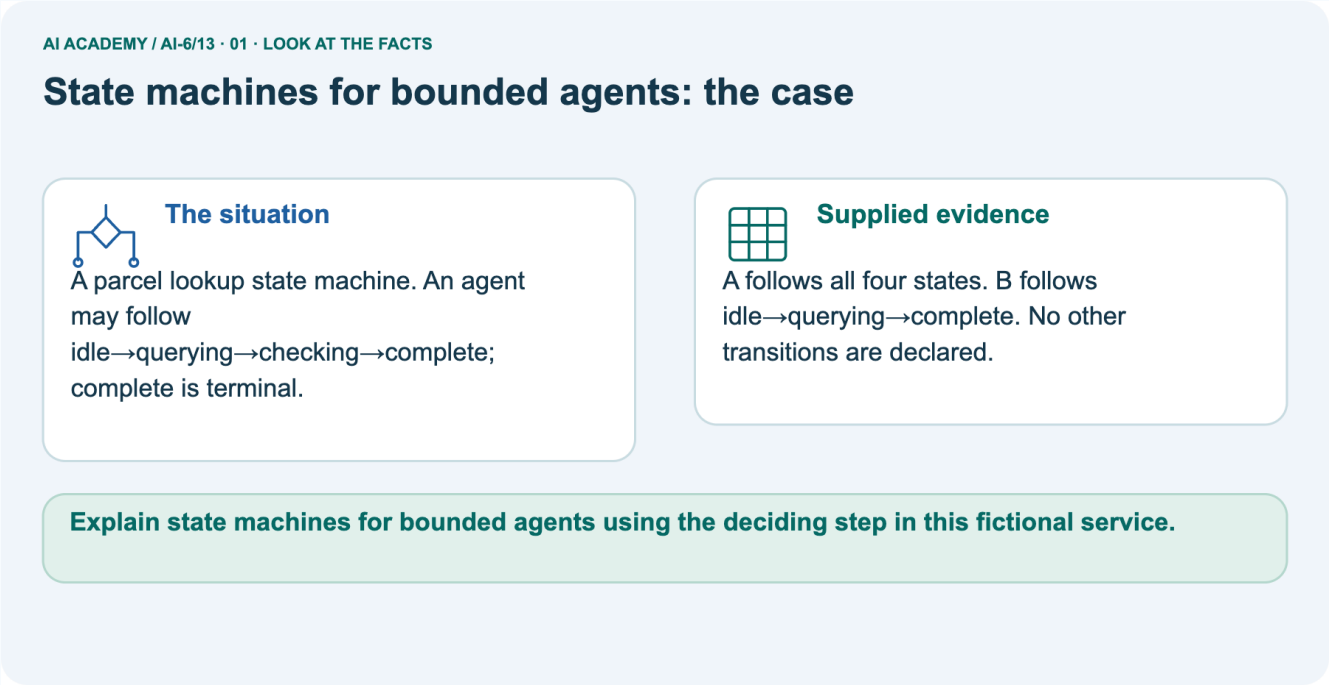
Collect the completed-work portfolio as **evidence**. Record support separately from correctness, and assess explanation, trace/test and limitations. Progress ticks and quiz selections alone do not establish mastery.

Visual concept journey

> Show one State machines for bounded agents graphic at a time, request a prediction and discuss its trace before the independent assessment.

Use one picture at a time. Hide a worked result before asking for a **prediction**, then reveal it for feedback. These are supported teaching cases; retain the separate independent assessment for a fresh first attempt.

01. State machines for bounded agents: the case



Follow the labelled picture with the matching explanation. Open the vector diagram

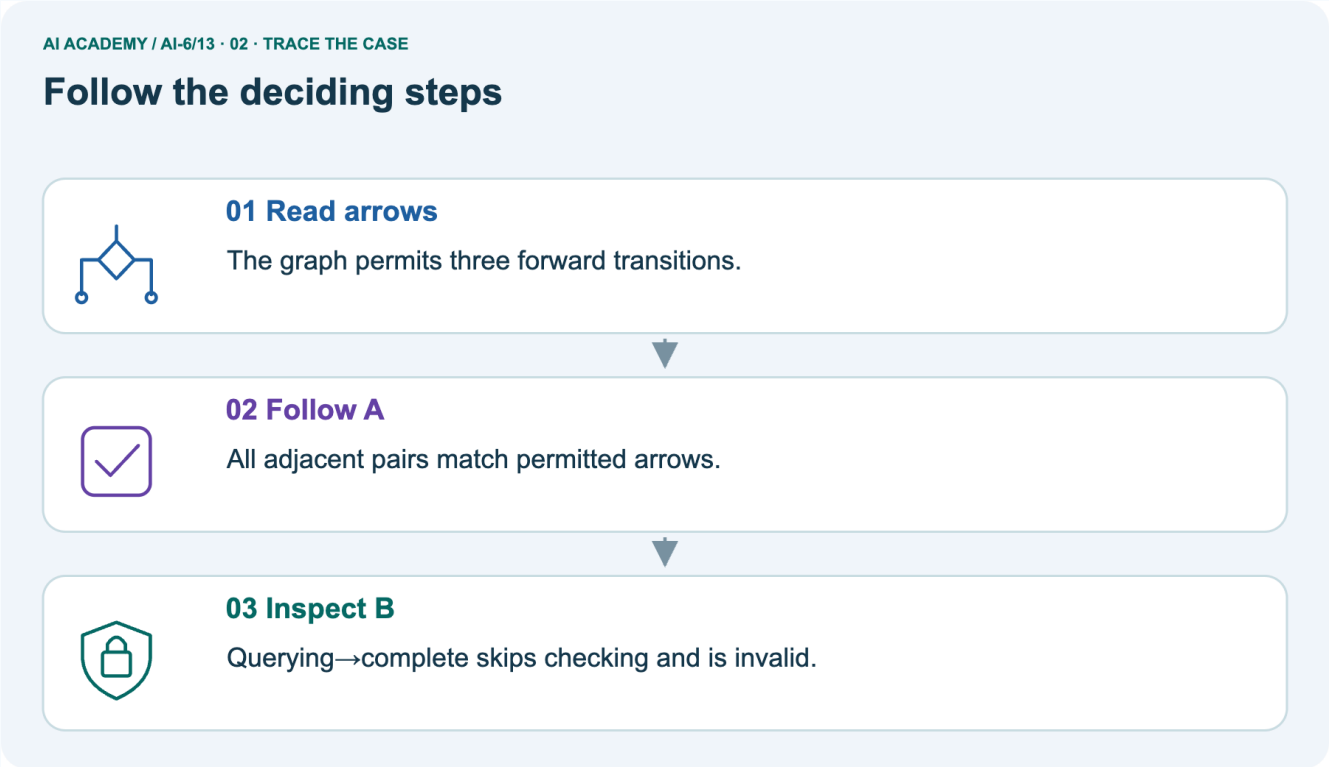
A parcel lookup **state** machine. An agent may follow idle→querying→checking→complete; complete is terminal. Supplied facts: A follows all four **state**s. B follows idle→querying→complete. No other **transition**s are declared.

Point to the given fact that matters most. Explain why it matters.

Discuss while showing the picture

Teacher prompt: Point to the given fact that matters most. Explain why it matters. Ask learners to describe one label or arrow in ordinary words. Use the adjacent transcript if the image is difficult to see.

02. Follow the deciding steps



Follow the labelled picture with the matching explanation. Open the vector diagram

Read arrows: The graph permits three forward **transition**s. → Follow A: All adjacent pairs match permitted arrows. → Inspect B: Querying→complete skips checking and is invalid.

Point to each numbered stage and explain which recorded **input** it uses.

Discuss while showing the picture

Teacher prompt: Point to each numbered stage and explain which recorded **input** it uses. Ask learners to describe one label or arrow in ordinary words. Use the adjacent transcript if the image is difficult to see.

03. State machines for bounded agents — evidence trace

AI ACADEMY / AI-6/13 · 03 · INSPECT THE LESSON MODEL

State machines for bounded agents — evidence trace

Input and scope	Check or calculation	Conclusion and limit
Trace ready -> looking_up -> review -> looking_up -> done.	States are ready, looking_up, review, done. ready may start lookup; lookup may finish done or request review; review may finish done after authorised evidence. done is terminal. Maximum two lookup attempts.	review -> looking_up is not allowed by this declared transition table, even if total attempts is two. Reject the transition or explicitly redesign and retest the table.

The figure connects this chapter's worked input, declared procedure and result. Read the complete worked reasoning for qualifiers and intermediate steps; the abbreviated labels do not replace that reasoning.

Follow the labelled picture with the matching explanation. Open the vector diagram

State machines for bounded agents — **evidence** trace.

Trace ready -> looking_up -> review -> looking_up -> done. | **State**s are ready, looking_up, review, done. ready may start lookup; lookup may finish done or request review; review may finish done after authorised **evidence**. done is terminal.

Maximum two lookup attempts. | review -> looking_up is not allowed by this declared **transition** table, even if total attempts is two. Reject the **transition** or explicitly redesign and retest the table.

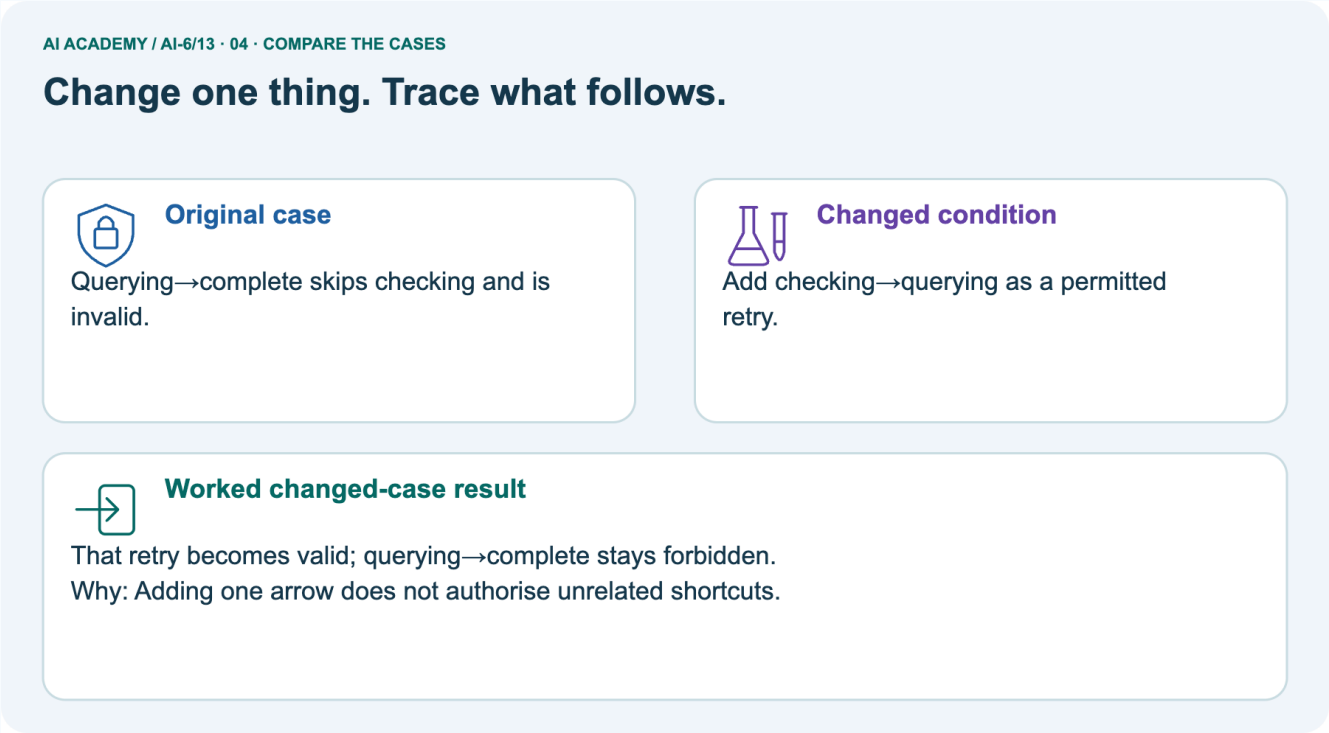
Read the labels and values. Explain the relationship the model shows.

Discuss while showing the picture

Teacher prompt: Read the labels and values. Explain the relationship the model shows. Ask learners to describe one label or arrow in ordinary words. Use the adjacent transcript if the

image is difficult to see.

04. Change one thing. Trace what follows.



Follow the labelled picture with the matching explanation. Open the vector diagram

Original case: Querying→complete skips checking and is invalid. Changed condition: Add checking→querying as a permitted retry. Expected result: That retry becomes valid; querying→complete stays forbidden.

Reason: Adding one arrow does not authorise unrelated shortcuts.

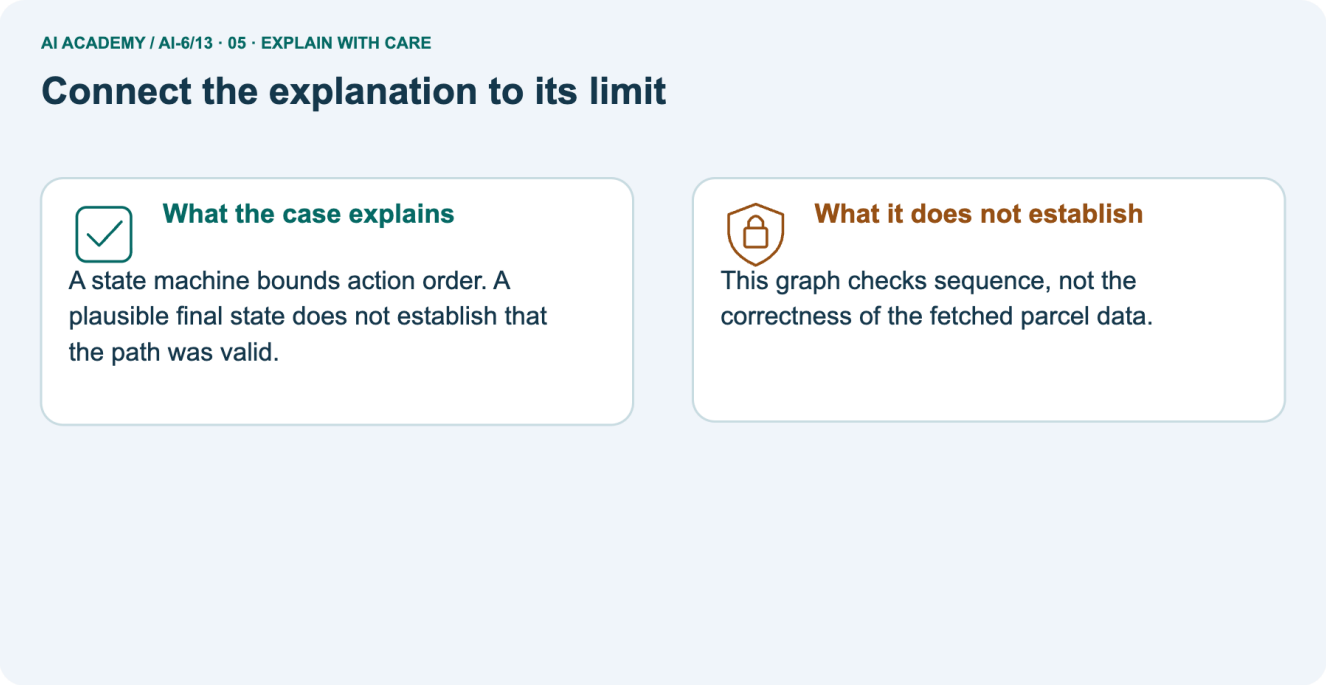
Predict before checking the worked changed-case result. Name what changed and what the supplied facts allow you to conclude.

Discuss while showing the picture

Teacher prompt: Predict before checking the worked changed-case result. Name what changed and what the supplied facts allow you to conclude. Ask learners to describe one label or arrow in ordinary words.

Use the adjacent transcript if the image is difficult to see. Changed-case reasoning: Adding one arrow does not authorise unrelated shortcuts.

05. Connect the explanation to its limit



Follow the labelled picture with the matching explanation. Open the vector diagram

A **state** machine bounds action order. A plausible final **state** does not establish that the path was valid. Limit: This graph checks sequence, not the correctness of the fetched parcel data.

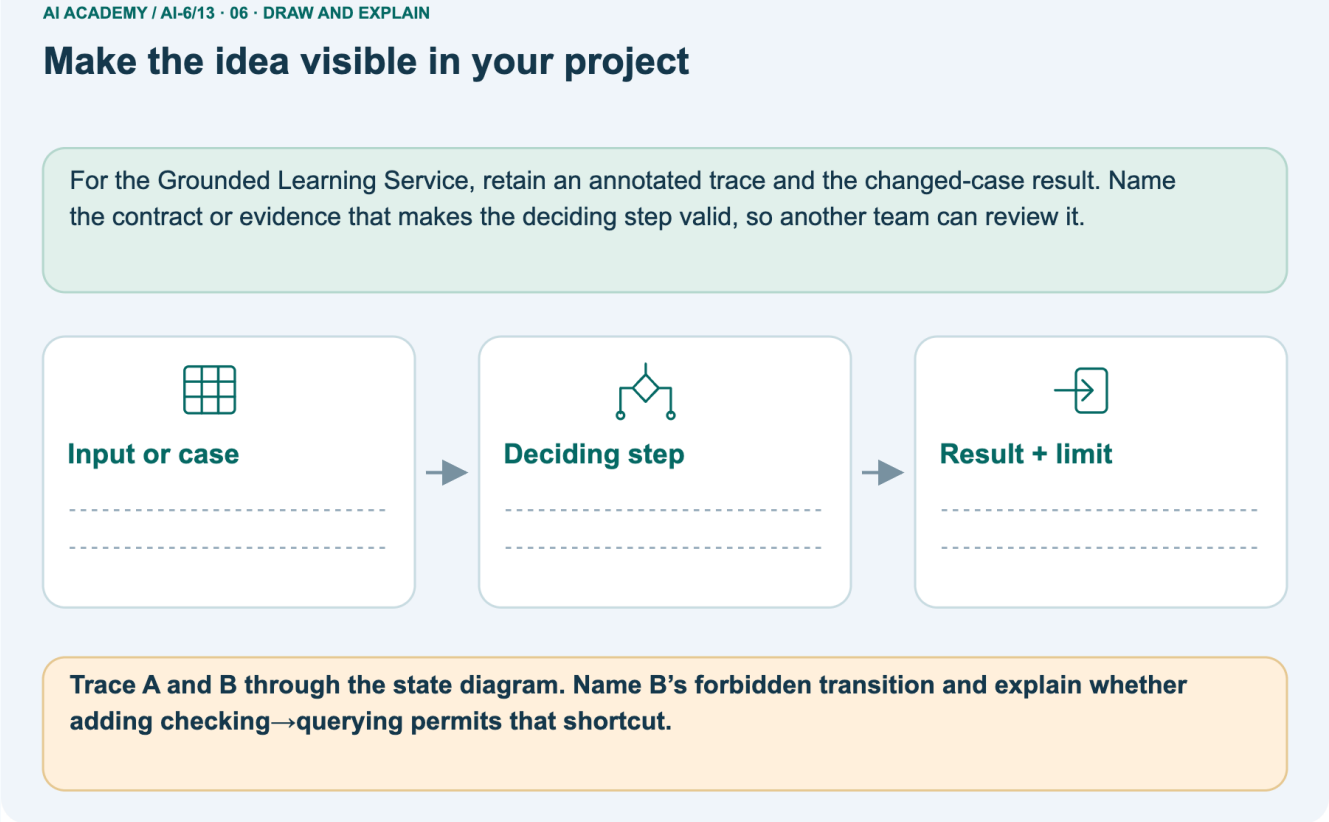
Explain the case, then point to a limit on the claim.

Discuss while showing the picture

Teacher prompt: Explain the case, then point to a limit on the claim. Ask learners to describe one label or arrow in ordinary words. Use the adjacent transcript if the image is difficult to see.

Keep the **state**d scope: This graph checks sequence, not the correctness of the fetched parcel data.

06. Make the idea visible in your project



Follow the labelled picture with the matching explanation. Open the vector diagram

For the Grounded Learning Service, retain an annotated trace and the changed-case result. Name the contract or **evidence** that makes the deciding step valid, so another team can review it.

Draw your **input**, deciding step, result and limit. Supported question: Trace A and B through the **state** diagram. Name B's forbidden **transition** and explain whether adding checking→querying permits that shortcut.

Draw your project trace and justify the deciding step using **evidence**.

Discuss while showing the picture

Teacher prompt: Draw your project trace and justify the deciding step using **evidence**. Ask learners to describe one label or arrow in ordinary words. Use the adjacent transcript if the image is difficult to see.

Supported practice key: The graph permits three forward **transition**s. All adjacent pairs match permitted arrows. Querying→complete skips checking and is invalid.

Changed case: That retry becomes valid; querying→complete stays forbidden. Adding one arrow does not authorise unrelated shortcuts.

Save or print your responses for your portfolio. Progress and drafts on the hosted website stay in the current browser. Use only fictional or teacher-approved data.